

YOUR EXACT WINDOWS COMMANDS — Copy & Paste Ready

For: Pablo's Windows PC (Acer C: drive)

This file has EVERY command you'll ever need, already filled in for YOUR computer.
No guessing, no tech knowledge needed — just **copy the blue boxes** into PowerShell.

FIRST TIME: Where to put the project

Best location: `C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models`

This puts it in your Documents folder where it's easy to find and safe.

How to open PowerShell (do this every time)

1. Press the **Windows key** (⊞ on your keyboard)
 2. Type: **PowerShell**
 3. Click **Windows PowerShell** (the blue one)
 4. A blue window opens — that's your terminal 
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STEP 0: Download the project from GitHub (one time only)

Option A: Download as ZIP (easiest)

1. Go to: <https://github.com/pabsanamono/soccer-betting-models>
2. Click the green **Code** button
3. Click **Download ZIP**
4. The file `soccer-betting-models-main.zip` downloads
5. **Right-click** the ZIP → **Extract All** → Choose `C:\Users\Pablo\Documents`
6. Rename the folder from `soccer-betting-models-main` to `soccer-betting-models`

OR

Option B: Use Git (if you have it installed)

Open PowerShell and paste this:

```
cd C:\Users\Pablo\Documents
git clone https://github.com/pabsanamono/soccer-betting-models.git
```

STEP 1.1: Go into the project folder

Every time you open PowerShell, paste this **FIRST**:

```
cd C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models
```

How to check it worked:

- The line should now say: `C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models>`
- If you see that,  you're in the right place!

Pro tip: After pasting, press **Enter**.

STEP 1.2: Create the virtual environment (one time only)

Copy and paste this:

```
python -m venv .venv
```

Press Enter. It takes 10–30 seconds. You'll see nothing happen — that's normal!

If you get “python not found”:

Try this instead:

```
py -m venv .venv
```

STEP 1.3: Activate the virtual environment

YOU MUST DO THIS EVERY TIME you open a new PowerShell window.

```
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

 **Success looks like this:**

```
(.venv) C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models>
```

See the `(.venv)` at the start? That means it's working!

If you get a red error about “execution policy”:

Run this **ONCE** (as Administrator):

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser
```

Then try the activate command again.

STEP 1.4: Install everything (one time only)

After activating, paste these two commands:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

(Wait 2-5 minutes... lots of text will scroll by)

Then:

```
pip install -e .
```

✅ Done! You never have to do this again (unless you delete the `.venv` folder).

STEP 2: Test it works (offline, no internet needed)

```
python examples/quickstart.py
```

You should see:

- Generating synthetic data...
- Comparing models...
- Backtest summary at the end

If you see that, 🎉 **EVERYTHING IS WORKING!**

STEP 3: Download real historical data (free, no API needed)

```
python scripts/collect_data.py
```

This downloads free match results + odds from the last few years.

STEP 4: Train a model

Pick one:

```
python scripts/train_models.py --model poisson
```

```
python scripts/train_models.py --model dixon_coles
```

```
python scripts/train_models.py --model elo
```

```
python scripts/train_models.py --model ml
```



STEP 5: Run a backtest

```
python scripts/run_backtest.py --model dixon_coles
```

This shows you how the model would have performed betting on past matches.



STEP 6: Find value bets

```
python scripts/find_value_bets.py data/processed/predictions.csv --min-edge 0.03
```



BONUS: Connect the live Odds API

Get your API key

1. Go to: <https://the-odds-api.com/>
2. Click **Get API Key**
3. Sign up (free)
4. Copy your key (looks like `a1b2c3d4e5f6...`)

Set the key in PowerShell

Paste this, but replace `YOUR_KEY_HERE` with your real key:

```
$env:ODDS_API_KEY = "YOUR_KEY_HERE"
```

Example (fake key):

```
$env:ODDS_API_KEY = "a1b2c3d4e5f6g7h8i9j0"
```

! Important: You must do this EVERY TIME you open a new PowerShell window.
(Or put it in a file — see “Future: Save the key permanently” below)

Turn on the API in the config

1. Open `C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models\config\config.yaml`
2. Find the line that says `enabled: false` (under `odds_api`)
3. Change it to `enabled: true`
4. Save the file

Test the API

Create a file `test_api.py` in the project folder with this:

```
from soccer_betting.data.collectors import TheOddsAPICollector

collector = TheOddsAPICollector(sport="soccer_epl", regions="eu", markets="h2h")
odds = collector.fetch_odds()

print(f"Got {len(odds)} odds rows")
print(odds.head())
```

Then run:

```
python test_api.py
```

If you see a table with team names and odds,  **IT WORKS!**



CHEAT SHEET: Every future session

Every time you want to use the project:

1. Open PowerShell
2. Paste these 2 commands:

```
cd C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

1. (Optional, if using the API) Set your key:

```
$env:ODDS_API_KEY = "your_key_here"
```

1. Then run whatever you need:

```
python examples/quickstart.py
python scripts/train_models.py --model dixon_coles
python scripts/run_backtest.py --model dixon_coles
```



FUTURE: Save the API key permanently (optional)

So you don't have to type it every time:

1. In the project folder, create a file called `.env` (note the dot at the start)
2. Inside, put:

```
ODDS_API_KEY=your_actual_key_here
```

3. Install the python-dotenv package:

```
powershell
pip install python-dotenv
```

4. At the top of any script where you use the API, add:

```
python
from dotenv import load_dotenv
load_dotenv()
```

Now it will read the key automatically! (And `.env` is in `.gitignore` so it won't upload to GitHub.)

TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Fix
<code>python</code> not found	Use <code>py</code> instead of <code>python</code> in all commands
<code>(.venv)</code> not showing after activate	Re-run: <code>.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1</code>
Red error about "execution policy"	Run as Admin: <code>Set-ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser</code>
<code>pip</code> not found	Make sure <code>(.venv)</code> is showing. If not, activate first.
Can't find the folder	Check the path: <code>C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models</code>
API says "No key"	Re-run: <code>\$env:ODDS_API_KEY = "your_key"</code> in the SAME PowerShell window

REMEMBER

- Always open PowerShell in the project folder: `cd C:\Users\Pablo\Documents\soccer-betting-models`
- Always activate first: `.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1`
- Look for `(.venv)` at the start of the line — if you don't see it, activate again!

Bookmark this file! 

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